

38 THE MINNEAPOLIS TRIBUNE ***** Thurs., Oct. 16, 1969



SID HARTMAN
 NEW YORK, N.Y.—Bill Rigney was talking on the telephone from his home in Walnut Creek, Calif. "Sure. I'd be interested in talking to Calvin Griffith about managing the Twins next year," said Rigney. "I never enjoyed myself any more than the years I managed the Minneapolis Millers. "In my book, the Minnesota fans are the best in baseball. I remember the thought that came to me as I watched the 1965 World Series in Minnesota. I said here are fans who deserve a World Series every three or four years. "I've always liked Calvin Griffith and their baseball ability. "I think the Twins have a fine ball club. "After being out of baseball since I left the Angels in the middle of the year (he was replaced by Lefty Phillips), I've missed managing. "I spent the summer doing some television color of the San Francisco Giant games and enjoyed it very much. But I would like to get back into uniform. I haven't heard from anybody yet. But if they want to talk I'll be receptive."

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Seattle Move: The American League is expected to vote in Chicago Sunday to transfer the Seattle franchise to Milwaukee for the start of the 1970 season.

As of last night, the only thing that was holding up the transfer was the absence of nine votes. Eddie Yost, a name being mentioned as one of the Twin managerial candidates, is in his 25th year in baseball but this is his first World Series. He is a Met coach.

Look for Jim Lemon to be one of the coaches of the 1970 Twins if he isn't the manager. . . . Chub Feeney, vice-president of the San Francisco Giants, is the odds-on favorite to succeed Warren Giles as National League president.

Feeney, whose mother is a prominent stockholder in the Giant team, hasn't decided whether he wants the job.

Favors Inter-league Play: Bowie Kuhn, the commissioner of baseball, favors inter-league play. But he doesn't see any chance of it in 1970. The baseball boss also doesn't look for realignment in the near future. . . . Three of the four times Earl Weaver, Baltimore manager, was chased from games during the past season came about in Met Stadium.

"I don't curse umpires and I can thank Andy Cohen (former Minneapolis Miller second baseman) who managed me at Denver in 1954," said Weaver. "After I had cursed out an umpire and was thrown out of the game, Cohen asked if I felt good about it. "I told Cohen that I felt lousy about it and that I was ashamed of myself. Andy pointed out something that made a deep impression on me. He said that the umpire can't fight back when you curse him out there, you are picking on a defenseless man. . . . Eddie Popowski, who managed the last Minneapolis Miller team in 1960, has been renamed to the Boston Red Sox coaching staff under new manager Eddie Kasko. The pitching coach will be Charley Wagner who pitched for the old Millers under Mike Kelly and was sold to the Red Sox, where he has been ever since. . . .

Gary Gentry, the winning Met pitcher in the third game of the World Series, won his nine game of the season against seven losses when he beat the Chicago Cubs on July 15. He didn't win another game until Sept. 2 and this may him 10-11. He won four out of five starts in September to give him a 13-12 record, with two of his three shutouts during that period. . . .

Mets Improving: Somebody asked Casey Stengel, manager of the world championship New York Yankees for many years and the Mets' first manager, how the present Mets compare with the good Yankee teams. He answered: "The Mets aren't quite as good yet. But they are on their way. . . . Joe DiMaggio, the former great Yankee outfielder, is here for the World Series. But he won't confirm the rumor that he won't return as vice-president and coach with Charley Finley at Oakland. . . .

Eddie Stanky, who helped develop some of the Mets in the 1962 Instructional League and helped the National League champions when, as manager of the Chicago White Sox, he traded Tommy Agee to the Mets, is being quoted as saying he wants to return to baseball as a coach for Leo Durocher, the Chicago Cub manager. . . .

Jottings: Mike Cuellar, who beat the Mets in the opening game and started a second time Wednesday, recalled posting a 2-2 record against the Mets last year as a pitcher for the Houston Astros. . . . Billy Hunter, the Baltimore coach who is one of the candidates being mentioned for the Twins job, turned down a chance to manage the Cincinnati Reds. He did sign a coaching pact with the Orioles for next year, but said he still was receptive to a managerial post.

Bob Scheffing, former Detroit manager and now a Met official, is being given credit for having done a great scouting job on the Baltimore Orioles. He followed them for three weeks. . . . Mayo Smith, manager of the Detroit Tigers, says he will shift Al Kaline to first base next year and alternate him there with Norm Cash. . . .

They Say: Tommy Agee, Met outfielder: "I'm indebted to Eddie Stanky for two reasons. First, he was the first manager to give me a chance to play in the major leagues as a regular for the Chicago White Sox. Second, when he traded me it was to the New York Mets. That gave me a chance to play for Gil Hodges, who has done so much for me."

Yogi Berra, Met coach: "I can sympathize with Billy Martin. I managed the New York Yankees to the seventh game in the 1964 World Series before we lost out to the St. Louis Cardinals. Then I was called down the morning after the final game and fired."

Tommy Agee, Mets outfielder: "We've got it in the bag now. We'd like to win it tomorrow (today), but we're going to win it one way or another."



BALTIMORE MANAGER EARL WEAVER WAS TOLD TO SHUT HIS 'DAMN MOUTH' Umpire Shag Crawford ejected manager for protesting call in third

FIRST 'HEAVE-HO' IN 34 YEARS
Weaver Gets Series Thumb

By DWAYNE NETLAND
 Minneapolis Tribune Staff Writer

NEW YORK, N.Y.—His team may be on the brink of elimination, but at least Earl Weaver, the Baltimore manager, had the distinction of joining a very exclusive company Wednesday.

Weaver became the first manager to be thrown out of a Series game in 34 years when he was ejected yesterday by plate umpire Shag Crawford in the third inning.

The last previous manager to get the thumb was Charley Grimm of the Chicago Cubs, who was chased by umpire George Moriarty in the 1935 Series against Detroit.

History does not record whether Grimm continued to direct Cub strategy from the clubhouse. There was no television in those days, so the best he could have done was to have received his information from the radio or a runner.

Weaver, without ever coming right out and saying so, took advantage of the electronic age and ran his Orioles from in front of the television set. He did, that is, until the Mets wipped him out in the 10th for their 2-1 victory.

"I'm saying 'no comment' if you ask me if I made any decisions affecting the ball game," Weaver said, "and no comment is what you'll get from any member of my staff. You can figure it out for yourself."

Weaver explained his exit in this fashion: "It was a pitch to (Mark) Belanger in the third in-

ning. I thought it was low. So did our whole bench. We all shouted out in unison. I kicked at something in the end of the dugout and yelled, as loudly as I could, 'We're not getting that pitch.'

"Crawford shook his finger at me, and said something I couldn't hear. I climbed up to have a talk with him, and he told me I was out of the game."

Weaver's relationship with umpires is, at best, an abrasive one. He sauntered out to home plate. "Shag," he said, "Shag." A little louder this time "Shag." "I really don't know what else I was going to say," Weaver said, because he told me to go.

Weaver told the umpire: "I guess you think you showed me up, but you showed yourself up even more." Crawford, a veteran National League umpire, defended the ouster.

"Weaver didn't cuss at me," he explained. "But he's been agitating the umpires throughout the Series and we just got sick of it. I told him to shut his damned mouth — if he didn't hear me then his ears are as bad as he thinks my eyes are. He knew what I said."

"Weaver was just trying to test me. He wasn't coming to the plate to say 'Hello.' He knows what a baseball rule is. A manager is not allowed to protest balls and strikes."

Bowie Kuhn, baseball commissioner, contended that the umpires were issued no special instructions regarding argu-

ments in the Series. "They were left on their own," he said, "to handle any situation as need be handled. Nothing was said about putting a muzzle on Weaver."

Weaver said the Orioles can still win the Series. "We're still alive even if we are backed into a corner."

That sentiment was echoed by Brooks Robinson, the great third baseman.

"Losing this game got us so mad we're liable to go out there and win three straight," he said. "Didn't Detroit do it last year?"

Robinson was still lamenting the catch that Ron Swoboda made on his liner to right center field with one out in the ninth. Frank Robinson scored after the catch, but Boog Powell who had singled Frank to third, would also have scored had the ball gone past Swoboda.

"I was sure it was in there for a base it," Brooks said. "I hit the ball on the nose."

Hit less firmly, but just as critical, was Jerry Grote's fly ball double that

dropped in front of Baltimore's Don Buford in left field to open the Mets' 10th. Buford started back for the ball, then came in, too late to make the play. "I saw it leave the bat," Buford said. "Then I lost it. I thought the ball was going to go a lot farther than it did." The play set up New York's winning run.

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